

VOICE LEADING HALL OF FAME

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #105

Voice Leading (aka. Guide Tones) is one of the best tools we have for organizing all the "correct notes" that we have learned how to play. How do we turn a parade of correct notes into a solo? How do we shape them into something akin to a melody? Voice Leading, baby!

The List Of Great Things Related To Voice Leading

- Chord Tones are really great. 3rd and 7ths are the greatest.
- Common tones between chords are great (#1 below, measures 5 and 6, below).
- 1/2 step motion between chords is great (#1 below, measure 2 moving to measure 3).
- Whole step motion is less great than 1/2 step, but still pretty great (#1, measure 6 to 7).
- A constant direction is great (#1, measures 1 - 7 below are entirely descending).
- Changing direction is also great (#1, measure 8, below, ascends from measure 7).

And then what? Treat the Voice Leading line like a favorite path through the woods. Walk on it a lot. Occasionally step off the path, but don't get lost. Keep the path nearby. Find little side trips off the path, but remember that the path is your friend.

#1 - "A" section of Bernie's Tune

Chord progression for the "A" section of Bernie's Tune:

Measure 1: Dm7 (G4)

Measure 2: Bb7 (Bb4)

Measure 3: Eø7 (G4)

Measure 4: A7(b9) (F#4)

Measure 5: Dm (E4)

Measure 6: Eø7 (D4)

Measure 7: A7(b9) (C4)

#2 - Embellishing the line with chord tones

Chord progression for embellishing the line with chord tones:

Measure 1: Dm7 (G4, A4, Bb4, A4, G4)

Measure 2: Bb7 (Bb4, A4, G4, F#4, E4)

Measure 3: Eø7 (G4, F#4, E4, D4)

Measure 4: A7(b9) (F#4, E4, D4, C4)

Measure 5: Dm (E4, D4, C4, Bb4)

Measure 6: Eø7 (D4, C4, Bb4, A4)

Measure 7: A7(b9) (G4, F#4, E4, D4)